Applicant Screening Scorecard

Nursing Styles | Companion, Home Health Aide, CNA, LPN, and RN applicants

How to use this workbook

Screening Form	Use one copy of this tab per phone screen. Fill the yellow cells. Knockouts take Yes, No, or N/A. Scores take 0 to 3. Totals and the decision fill in automatically.
Applicant Tracker	One row per applicant. Enter knockout answers and question scores; the total, percent, and decision calculate on their own. Copy the final row into AxisCare notes.
Interview	Used by the interviewing manager. Same 0 to 3 scale, with an automatic total and recommendation.
Questions and Rubric	The full question set with what a good answer looks like, weights, and the score scale.
Score scale	3 = Strong: specific, confident, matches our needs. 2 = Solid: reasonable with some detail. 1 = Limited: vague or minimal fit. 0 = Concern: wrong, unsafe, or no answer.
Weighted total	Each score is multiplied by its weight (1 or 2). Maximum is 84 points.
Advance	63 points or more (75% or more) and no knockouts. Invite to interview within 3 business days.
Hold or second look	46 to 62 points (55% to 74%). Coordinator and office administrator review together; advance if the applicant fills a hard to staff need.
Do not advance	45 points or fewer, or any knockout answered No. Send the not moving forward message.
Keep it legal	Ask only job related questions. Never ask about age, race, national origin, citizenship, religion, marital or family status, pregnancy, disability or health, medications, genetic information, sexual orientation, gender identity, or arrests. Physicals and TB tests come only
Volunteered information	If an applicant shares personal information that is not job related, do not record it here.

Phone Screening Questions and Rubric

Ask every applicant the same questions in the same order.

#	Topic	Ask	What a good answer looks like	Weight	Type
1	Position and motivation	Which position are you most interested in, and what draws you to home care?	Names a role; talks about caring for people, purpose, or a personal experience; shows they understand home care is one-on-one in a client's home.	2	Scored
2	Experience	Tell me about your caregiving experience. Where, how long, and what kinds of clients?	Specific settings, length of time, and client types (seniors, dementia, post hospital). Family caregiving counts for companion roles.	2	Scored
3	Certifications	Which certifications or licenses do you hold right now? (CNA, HHA training certificate, LPN, RN, CPR, first aid.) When do they expire?	Can name each credential and expiration date. For HHA, CNA, and nurse roles, holds the required credential or a clear plan; CPR current or willing to get it before starting.	2	Scored
4	Background screening	This role requires a Level 2 fingerprint background screening through Florida's AHCA Clearinghouse. Are you willing to complete it? Have you been fingerprinted for a Florida health care employer in the past five years?	Yes, without hesitation. Prior Clearinghouse screening is a plus (may speed clearance). Do not ask about arrests.		Knockout
5	Work authorization	Are you legally authorized to work in the United States? Will you now or in the future need sponsorship for employment visa status?	Yes to authorization. Ask only these two questions; do not ask about citizenship, birthplace, or immigration status.		Knockout
6	Availability by day	Which days of the week are you available to work?	Clear days listed. More days, and any weekend days, score higher.	2	Scored
7	Availability by shift	Which shifts work for you: mornings, afternoons, evenings, overnights, 12 hour shifts, 24 hour or live-in, weekends, holidays?	Clear shifts listed. Nights, weekends, and holidays are our hardest to fill and score highest.	2	Scored
8	Hours	About how many hours a week would you like to work?	A number or range that fits our open cases; flexible is a plus.	1	Scored
9	Transportation	Do you have a valid Florida driver's license, a reliable vehicle with air conditioning, and auto insurance? Are you comfortable driving clients to appointments and errands?	Yes to all; comfortable driving clients. Out of state license with a plan to transfer is a Hold.		Knockout
10	Preferred areas	Which counties or areas do you prefer to work in (Pinellas, Pasco, Manatee, Sarasota), and how far are you willing to drive to a client?	Names counties near our open cases; willing to drive 20 to 30 minutes or more.	2	Scored
11	Dementia care	Tell me about a time you cared for someone with memory loss. What would you do if a client with dementia became upset and insisted on leaving the house?	Stays calm, reassures, redirects, keeps the client safe, does not argue, calls the office. Experience is a plus; a thoughtful answer counts.	2	Scored
12	Personal care	How comfortable are you with personal care such as bathing, dressing, toileting, and incontinence care? (HHA, CNA, nurse roles.) For companion roles: this role does not include hands-on care; is that a fit for you?	Comfortable and respectful; mentions privacy and dignity. For companions, understands the boundary.	2	Scored
13	Lifting and transfers	Our clients often need help moving, including transfers from bed to chair with a gait belt, and sometimes a Hoyer lift. Can you perform these tasks, with or without a reasonable accommodation? Have you used a Hoyer lift?	Yes; describes safe technique (body mechanics, asks for help, uses equipment). Never ask about medical conditions or why they might not be able to.	2	Scored

14	Pets and smoking	Some client homes have dogs, cats, or other pets, and some have smokers. Are you comfortable working in homes with pets? With smoking in the home?	Honest answer. This is for matching, not scoring against them. Note any homes to avoid.		Information only
15	Languages	Our clients speak a variety of languages. Besides English, do you speak, read, or write any other languages fluently?	Any fluent language is a plus for matching. Ask only about languages spoken, never about national origin.	1	Scored
16	Reliability scenario	You're on your way to a client and realize you'll be 20 minutes late. What do you do?	Calls the office right away (not just the client), gives an arrival time, and follows our call-out process. Shows ownership.	2	Scored
17	Safety scenario	Your client falls while you are helping them to the bathroom. Walk me through what you do.	Does not lift an injured client alone; checks for injury; calls 911 if hurt or unsure; calls the office; documents. Stays with the client.	2	Scored
18	Start date	If we move forward, when could you start? Do you need to give notice anywhere?	Can start within 1 to 2 weeks, or a clear date.	1	Scored
19	Pay expectations	What hourly pay are you looking for?	Within the range management sets for the role. Out of range is a conversation, not a knockout.	1	Scored
20	References	Can you provide two references, ideally supervisors from caregiving or other jobs?	Yes, with supervisors named.	1	Scored
21	Their questions	What questions do you have for us?	Asks about clients, schedule, training, or the team. Shows genuine interest.	1	Scored

Nurse add-on questions (LPN and RN, information for the interviewer)

#	Topic	Ask	What a good answer looks like		
N1	License	Please share your Florida or compact license number so we can verify it. Any restrictions?	Active license, no restrictions, verifiable on the DOH license lookup.		
N2	Skills	Which skills are you current in: IV therapy and PICC care, injections, wound care, catheter and ostomy care, tube feeding?	Specific, recent examples; honest about refreshers needed.		
N3	Change in condition	How do you handle a change in a patient's condition when you're the only clinician in the home?	Assesses, acts within scope, calls physician and Director of Nursing, documents.		
N4	Supervision (RN)	Have you supervised aides or CNAs, or completed home health assessments and care plans?	Yes, with examples.		

Score scale

Score	Meaning	Example (Q11 dementia care)
3	Strong: specific, confident, matches what we need	Describes redirecting a client with dementia, staying calm, and calling the office, with a real example.
2	Solid: reasonable answer with some detail	Has not worked with dementia but describes a calm, safe approach.
1	Limited: vague or minimal fit	"I'd just tell them to sit down."

0	Concern: wrong, unsafe, or no answer	Would argue with the client or restrain them.

Knockout criteria

ID	Knockout check	Applies to
K1	Willing to complete Level 2 background screening (Q4)	All roles
K2	Legally authorized to work in the U.S. (Q5)	All roles
K3	Valid driver's license, reliable vehicle with A/C, and auto insurance (Q9)	All roles unless management approves an exception
K4	Holds the required credential or has a clear plan (HHA 40 hour training, active CNA, LPN or RN license)	HHA, CNA, LPN, RN (mark N/A for companion)
K5	Willing to provide hands-on personal care (Q12)	HHA, CNA (mark N/A for companion)
K6	Availability matches an open need, or applicant is flexible (Q6, Q7)	All roles

Phone Screen: Single Applicant

Fill the yellow cells. Totals and decision calculate automatically.

Applicant name	
Position	
Office (Largo or Sarasota)	
Preferred counties	
Phone screen date	
Screened by	
Phone	
Email	
OK to text (Yes or No)	

Knockout checks

ID	Check	Answer (Yes, No, N/A)	Notes
K1	Willing to complete Level 2 background screening (Q4)		
K2	Legally authorized to work in the U.S. (Q5)		
K3	Valid driver's license, reliable vehicle with A/C, and auto insurance (Q9)		
K4	Holds the required credential or has a clear plan (HHA 40 hour training, active CNA, LPN or RN license)		
K5	Willing to provide hands-on personal care (Q12)		
K6	Availability matches an open need, or applicant is flexible (Q6, Q7)		

Scored questions

#	Question	Score (0 to 3)	Weight	Weighted	Notes
1	Position and motivation: Which position are you most interested in, and what draws you to home care?		2		
2	Experience: Tell me about your caregiving experience. Where, how long, and what kinds of clients?		2		
3	Certifications: Which certifications or licenses do you hold right now? (CNA, HHA training certificate, LPN, RN, CPR, first aid.) When do they expire?		2		
6	Availability by day: Which days of the week are you available to work?		2		
7	Availability by shift: Which shifts work for you: mornings, afternoons, evenings, overnights, 12 hour shifts, 24 hour or live-in, weekends, holidays?		2		

8	Hours: About how many hours a week would you like to work?		1		
10	Preferred areas: Which counties or areas do you prefer to work in (Pinellas, Pasco, Manatee, Sarasota), and how far are you willing to drive to a client?		2		
11	Dementia care: Tell me about a time you cared for someone with memory loss. What would you do if a client with dementia became upset and insisted on leaving the house?		2		
12	Personal care: How comfortable are you with personal care such as bathing, dressing, toileting, and incontinence care? (HHA, CNA, nurse roles.) For companion roles: this role does not include hands-on care; is that a fit for		2		
13	Lifting and transfers: Our clients often need help moving, including transfers from bed to chair with a gait belt, and sometimes a Hoyer lift. Can you perform these tasks, with or without a reasonable accommodation? Have		2		
15	Languages: Our clients speak a variety of languages. Besides English, do you speak, read, or write any other languages fluently?		1		
16	Reliability scenario: You're on your way to a client and realize you'll be 20 minutes late. What do you do?		2		
17	Safety scenario: Your client falls while you are helping them to the bathroom. Walk me through what you do.		2		
18	Start date: If we move forward, when could you start? Do you need to give notice anywhere?		1		
19	Pay expectations: What hourly pay are you looking for?		1		
20	References: Can you provide two references, ideally supervisors from caregiving or other jobs?		1		
21	Their questions: What questions do you have for us?		1		

Information for matching (not scored)

14	Pets and smoking: Some client homes have dogs, cats, or other pets, and some have smokers. Are you comfortable working in homes with pets?	

-	Days available	
-	Shifts available (mornings, afternoons, evenings, overnights, 12 hour, 24 hour or live-in, weekends, holidays)	
-	Languages spoken fluently	
-	Earliest start date	
-	Pay expectation (hourly)	
-	Hoyer lift experience (Yes or No)	

Results

Questions scored	**0 of 17**
Weighted total	**0**
Maximum possible	**84**
Percent	
Knockouts answered No	**0**
Decision	
Next step	

Interviewer summary for the calendar invite

Applicant Tracker

One row per applicant. Yellow cells are inputs; gray cells calculate.

K1 Level 2 | K2 Work authorization | K3 License, vehicle, insurance | K4 Required credential | K5 Personal care | K6 Availability

Weight													2	2	2	2	2	1	2	2	2	2	1	2	2	1	1	1	1										
Date applied	Applicant name	Position	Office	Preferred counties	Phone screen date	Screened by	K1	K2	K3	K4	K5	K6	Q1 Position and motivation	Q2 Experience	Q3 Certifications	Q6 Availability by day	Q7 Availability by shift	Q8 Hours	Q10 Preferred areas	Q11 Dementia care	Q12 Personal care	Q13 Lifting and transfers	Q15 Languages	Q16 Reliability scenario	Q17 Safety scenario	Q18 Start date	Q19 Pay expectations	Q20 References	Q21 Their questions	Weighted total	Percent	Knockouts (No)	Decision	Interview date	Interviewer	Interview total	Outcome	AxisCare status	Notes

Management Interview Scoring

Same 0 to 3 scale. Fill the yellow cells.

Applicant name	
Position	
Interview date	
Interviewer	
Format (in person or video	

#	Topic	Ask	What a good answer looks like	Score (0 to 3)	Weight	Weighted	Notes
1	Why Nursing Styles	What made you want to work with Nursing Styles and with seniors in their homes?	Genuine, specific motivation; understands one-on-one care.		1		
2	Client dignity	Tell me about a time you helped someone keep their dignity during personal care or a hard moment.	Specific story; privacy, choice, respect.		2		
3	Dementia	Walk me through how you would spend a four hour shift with a client with moderate dementia.	Routine, engagement, redirection, safety, notes to office.		2		
4	Communication	How do you keep a family and the office informed about a change you noticed in a client?	Reports promptly to office or nurse, documents facts, stays within role.		2		
5	Reliability	Tell me about a time you had to cover a shift or a schedule changed at the last minute.	Flexible, communicates early, follows call-out process.		2		
6	Boundaries	A client offers you a gift or asks you to run a personal errand off the clock. What do you do?	Politely declines, explains agency policy, tells the office.		2		
7	Safety and transfers	Describe a safe bed to chair transfer, and when you would not do it alone.	Body mechanics, gait belt, equipment, asks for help, never risky lifts.		2		
8	Skills check	Role specific: HHA or CNA personal care steps; nurse clinical skills from N1 to N4.	Accurate, confident, within scope.		2		
9	Professionalism	Presentation, punctuality, documents brought, questions asked.	On time, prepared, engaged.		1		

Weighted total	**0**
Maximum possible	**48**
Percent	
Recommendation	
Final decision (manager)	

Reminder: a hire is a conditional offer, pending Level 2 clearance, references, physical and TB screening, license verification, and Form I-9.